

Japan

Rights Dimension (R1–R10)

Measures how strongly the framework protects individuals from AI harms. Max raw score: 20.

Code	Indicator & Justification	Score
R1	Binding comprehensive AI law with individual rights provisions The AI Promotion Act explicitly avoids binding obligations. The Act uses duties to endeavour (doryoku gimu) throughout, which are non-binding aspirational obligations with no legal enforcement mechanism. ZeLo confirmed: Japan's new law explicitly avoids punitive measures, signalling a policy preference for voluntary compliance. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent
R2	Explicit list of prohibited AI use categories in binding law No prohibited AI use cases exist anywhere in Japanese law. The AI Promotion Act does not enumerate any forbidden AI applications. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent
R3	Legal right to explanation for automated AI decisions METI AI Guidelines for Business v1.1 (March 2025) recommend providing transparency and clear user information about AI use and limitations. AIGA's AI Governance Navigator includes transparency criteria. These are non-binding guidelines, not enforceable legal rights. Score 1.	Score 1 — Soft / partial / sector-specific
R4	Legal right to human review of AI decisions METI Guidelines recommend keeping humans in the loop for decisions significantly affecting individuals and monitoring AI systems post-deployment. Non-binding. Score 1.	Score 1 — Soft / partial / sector-specific
R5	Legal right to contest or appeal AI-driven decisions METI Guidelines mention the importance of user redress mechanisms. The Act allows government investigation of misuse. No specific binding right to contest AI decisions. Score 1.	Score 1 — Soft / partial / sector-specific

R6	Anti-discrimination provisions specifically targeting AI General anti-discrimination law applies to AI-driven decisions. METI Guidelines address bias testing. No AI-specific anti-discrimination provision. Score 1.	Score 1 — Soft / partial / sector-specific
R7	Independent enforcement body acting on behalf of individuals The AI Strategic Headquarters (chaired by Prime Minister, includes all Cabinet ministers) coordinates policy but has no enforcement mandate or sanctioning powers. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent
R8	Meaningful financial penalties calibrated to harm or global turnover The AI Promotion Act contains no financial penalties for non-compliance. This is explicitly by design. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent
R9	Restrictions on biometric surveillance or invasive AI in binding law No restrictions on biometric surveillance or invasive AI use in any binding Japanese law. The Act on Protection of Personal Information applies to personal data but does not specifically restrict AI-based biometric surveillance in public spaces. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent
R10	Constitutional or treaty-level AI rights protection No constitutional or treaty-level AI rights protection in Japan. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent

Market Dimension (M1–M10)

Measures how strongly governance relies on voluntary, industry-led mechanisms. Max raw score: 20.

Code	Indicator & Justification	Score
M1	Primary governance mechanism is voluntary, not legally binding The AI Promotion Act is explicitly non-binding. Duties to endeavour have no legal enforcement mechanism. Score 2.	Score 2 — Binding / comprehensive

M2	Industry self-governance is the primary compliance mechanism AIGA and multiple industry self-governance bodies are the primary compliance mechanisms. AIGA's AI Governance Navigator was adopted by 47 companies in its first three months of operation. The International Bar Association confirmed broad corporate participation in voluntary AI governance groups. Score 2.	Score 2 — Binding / comprehensive
M3	Innovation promotion explicitly mandated in governance framework Article 1 of the AI Promotion Act explicitly states the purpose as promoting the development, research, and utilisation of AI. The AI Basic Plan sets the goal of making Japan the world's most AI-friendly nation. Score 2.	Score 2 — Binding / comprehensive
M4	No binding financial penalties exist for AI violations The AI Promotion Act contains no financial penalties. No AI-specific financial penalties exist anywhere in Japanese law. Score 2.	Score 2 — Binding / comprehensive
M5	Formal regulatory sandbox or experimental zone for AI METI has piloted experimental zones for AI applications. Sandbox programmes exist in the financial sector under FSA supervision. Not as formally structured as the EU's mandatory national sandboxes. Score 1.	Score 1 — Soft / partial / sector-specific
M6	Framework is principles-based rather than prescriptive-rules-based Japan's entire AI governance framework is principles-based. The METI Guidelines provide high-level principles rather than prescriptive rules. Score 2.	Score 2 — Binding / comprehensive
M7	No dedicated enforcement body with AI sanctioning powers No AI-specific regulatory body with sanctioning powers. The AI Strategic Headquarters is a coordination body, not an enforcement body. Score 2.	Score 2 — Binding / comprehensive
M8	Compliance is primarily self-assessed, not externally audited All AI compliance in Japan is self-assessed. Companies participate voluntarily in METI expert consultations. Score 2.	Score 2 — Binding / comprehensive

M9	Explicit alignment with international voluntary standards (OECD, ISO 42001) Japan authored the G7 Hiroshima AI Process principles (2023) and is a leading advocate for OECD AI Principles. Prof. Hiroki Habuka (AIGA co-founder) developed the pluralistic interoperability concept. Japan actively participates in ISO/IEC 42001 standard development. Score 2.	Score 2 — Binding / comprehensive
M10	Light-touch, pro-industry approach explicitly stated in official policy The AI Basic Plan (December 2025) explicitly sets the national goal of being the world's most AI-friendly nation. Score 2.	Score 2 — Binding / comprehensive

Sovereign Dimension (S1–S10)

Measures how strongly the state directs and controls AI development and deployment. Max raw score: 20.

Code	Indicator & Justification	Score
S1	AI outputs must comply with state values or ideology in binding law No requirement for AI outputs to comply with state values. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent
S2	Mandatory state registration required before AI deployment No mandatory state registration. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent
S3	National security provisions give state broad AI override powers Japan's Self-Defence Force AI guidelines and National Security Strategy (2022) create carve-outs for national security AI. Score 1.	Score 1 — Soft / partial / sector-specific
S4	State directs AI development priorities through binding strategic mandate The AI Basic Plan sets strategic directions for AI development through non-binding policy guidance, not a binding mandate. Score 1.	Score 1 — Soft / partial / sector-specific
S5	Data localization requirements affecting AI training or deployment No data localization requirements. Japan supports cross-border data flows through the Data Free Flow with Trust (DFFT) initiative. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent
S6	Restrictions on foreign AI providers or models in binding law No restrictions on foreign AI providers. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent

S7	State ownership or investment explicitly directs AI development The one trillion yen five-year AI support scheme and METI strategic AI investment programmes reflect significant state direction of AI development. Score 1.	Score 1 — Soft / partial / sector-specific
S8	State surveillance AI explicitly authorized or mandated in law No explicit authorization of state surveillance AI. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent
S9	Content moderation requirements serving state political interests No content moderation requirements serving state political interests. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent
S10	State pre-approval required for AI deployment No pre-approval requirement. Score 0.	Score 0 — Absent

Derived Coordinates

Ternary coordinates (r, m, s) are computed directly from the raw indicator sums. The compass rx coordinate is derived as $(r - s) \times 1.15$, capped at $[-1, +1]$. Bind score reflects enforcement strength independently of the ternary position.

Rights (R)	4	20	r = 0.15
Market (M)	19	20	m = 0.73
Sovereign (S)	3	20	s = 0.12
Total	26	60	Enforcement (bind): 12%

$$r = 4 \div 26 = 0.15 \quad m = 19 \div 26 = 0.73 \quad s = 1.00 - 0.15 - 0.73 = 0.12$$